

emitter, allowing any object to emit particles. Particle Cloud creates particles within a user-defined volume. This is good for clouds or other types of effects that need to be confined to a specific area.

9.1.2 Particle Types

Each particle system is slightly different, but they can create many of the same types of particles. These can be standard particles, instanced geometry, or blobby meta particles. The Particle Type rollout, available in Super Spray, Blizzard, PArray, and PCloud, contains all the basic particle types.

- Triangle creates flat triangular shaped particles.

- Special creates particle shapes consisting of three intersecting planes.

- Constant creates circular shaped particles.

- Six Point creates particles shaped like six pointed stars.

- Cube creates cube-shaped particles. Facing creates planar particles that always face the camera.

- Tetra creates tetrahedral-shaped particles.

- Sphere creates spherical particles.

- Meta particles are blobby particles that create fluid like effects.

- Instanced Geometry allows you to use any 3ds Max object as a particle.

9.1.3 Particle Generation

In addition to the type of particle, the particle system needs to know how the particles will be generated. This information includes the number of particles, their speed, and the length of time that the particles will live. Use Rate creates a specific number of particles per frame. Use Total creates a fixed number of particles over the life of the system. Particle Motion determines the speed of the particles with a Variation control to randomise the speed. The size of the particles, along with a Variation spinner adds to the randomness. The number of frames it takes to grow the particle to full size and the number of frames to fade it out from full size is decided under the Particle Timing menu. A random number needs to be used to initialise the system. You can directly set the frames where the particles start and stop emitting, and the frame where the particles disappear, regardless of other settings can also be set in the Particle Generation Panel.

9.1.4 Particle Motion

In addition to speed, particles can rotate and collide with each other as well as spawn new particles when they collide with other objects. This adds